

Deploying and updating the dashboard

Setup and operating guide — Dengue Situation Dashboard, CHAI Cambodia

This guide covers the whole life of the dashboard: publishing it to the web the first time, updating the data each week, and putting each update live. Parts 1 and 2 are done once. Parts 3 and 4 are the weekly routine.

Part 1: Before you start

You need four things. Check them once.

What	Why	How to check
Python on your computer	The update script is written in Python	Double-click UPDATE-DASHBOARD.bat. If it prints “Using: py -3” you are set
A GitHub account	GitHub hosts the website, free	Sign in at www.github.com
The project folder	Holds the workbook, the scripts, and the site	It contains index.html, a Data folder, and UPDATE-DASHBOARD.bat
Microsoft Excel	To type in the weekly numbers	Open Dengue_Master_Data_Entry.xlsx

If Windows opens the Microsoft Store when you try to run the script, Python is not really installed. That Store entry is a placeholder. Install Python from www.python.org and select “Add Python to PATH” during setup.

Part 2: Publish the dashboard for the first time

Do this once. After it is done, updating is only Parts 3 and 4.

Step 1: Create a repository on GitHub

1. Sign in at www.github.com and click **New** to create a repository.
2. Give it a name, for example dengue-dashboard.
3. Set it to **Public**. GitHub Pages needs this on a free account.
4. Do not add a README, a .gitignore, or a license. Leave those unticked.
5. Click **Create repository**.

Step 2: Upload the project files

On the new empty repository page, click **uploading an existing file**, then drag in the contents of the project folder. Upload these:

- index.html
- The whole **Data** folder, with its three files inside
- .nojekyll, if your computer shows hidden files

Scroll down and click **Commit changes**.

Keep the shape of the folder. Data must sit beside index.html, not inside another folder. If Data ends up nested, the dashboard will load with an error message where the charts should be.

The Excel workbook and the scripts do not need to go to GitHub. They stay on your computer. Uploading them does no harm, but nothing on the website reads them.

Step 3: Turn on GitHub Pages

1. In the repository, click **Settings**.
2. In the left menu, click **Pages**.
3. Under “Build and deployment”, set **Source** to “Deploy from a branch”.
4. Choose branch **main** and folder **/ (root)**, then click **Save**.

Step 4: Open your live site

Wait between thirty seconds and two minutes. The same Settings and Pages screen then shows your web address. It looks like this, with your own user name and repository name:

<https://your-user-name.github.io/dengue-dashboard/>

Open it. You should see the dashboard with the Cambodia tab loaded. **Write this address down** — you will use it every week to check your updates went live, and it is what you share with colleagues.

Part 3: Update the data each week

Step 1: Type the new numbers into Excel

Open `Dengue_Master_Data_Entry.xlsx` and go to the **National_Monthly_Entry** sheet. Scroll to the bottom and add one row per province for the reporting month. Fill in only the first five columns.

Column	Heading	What to type
A	Province	Must match the spelling in the Lookup_Lists sheet exactly
B	Year	Four digits, for example 2026

Column	Heading	What to type
C	Month	Three letters, for example Aug
D	Cases	Number of cases that month
E	Deaths	Number of deaths that month
F-H	CFR, Population, IR	Leave alone – these fill in automatically

Step 2: Check the QA sheet

Open the **QA_Checklist** sheet in the same workbook. It runs eight automatic checks on what you just typed: missing values, deaths higher than cases, duplicate province-month rows, populations that did not link, and implausible fatality rates.

Fix anything it flags. Then **save and close** the workbook – the script reads the saved file from disk, so an unsaved Excel window means it quietly uses last week's numbers.

Step 3: Run the update

Double-click **UPDATE-DASHBOARD.bat**. A black window opens and works through two steps: your national data first, then the World Health Organization (WHO) global download. It takes under a minute.

Read the last few lines. There are three possible endings.

What it says	What it means	What to do next
DONE - both updates finished.	Everything refreshed normally	Go to Part 4 and upload both files it names
DONE - but only partly.	WHO could not be reached – no internet, or their server is down. Your national data still updated correctly	Go to Part 4 and upload the one file it names
STOPPED	The national step failed and nothing was saved	Do not upload anything. Read the error above it, fix the workbook, and run again

Part 4: Publish the update

Step 1: Upload the changed file or files

1. Open your repository on GitHub and click into the **Data** folder.
2. Click **Add file**, then **Upload files**.
3. Drag in the file or files the script named, taken from the Data folder on your computer.
4. Scroll down and click **Commit changes**.

Keep the filenames exactly as they are. GitHub replaces the old versions.

You never re-upload index.html for a data update. Only files inside the Data folder change from week to week.

Step 2: Confirm it went live

Wait about a minute, then open your web address and check that the headline figures match what you typed. If it still shows the old numbers, wait one more minute and refresh.

You do not need to ask anyone to clear their browser cache. The page checks for fresh data every time it loads.

Part 5: Preview on your own computer first (optional)

If you would rather see an update before the public does, you can run the dashboard locally. This is optional and changes nothing on the website.

1. Open the project folder.
2. Click in the address bar at the top of the folder window, type cmd, and press Enter.
3. Type this and press Enter:

```
py -m http.server 8000
```

4. Open a browser and go to <http://localhost:8000>
5. When finished, click back on the black window and press Ctrl and C together.

Opening index.html by double-clicking it will not work – the charts will be missing and the page will show an error. Browsers block pages opened straight from disk from loading their own data files. The small local server above is the way around it.

Part 6: When something goes wrong

What you see	What it means	What to do
The Microsoft Store opens	Python is not really installed	Install Python from www.python.org , selecting “Add Python to PATH”
Sheet ... not found	A sheet was renamed or deleted in the workbook	Restore the original sheet name exactly
Required file not found	The script has been separated from the Excel file	Keep the whole folder together; do not move single files out of it

What you see	What it means	What to do
Could not reach the WHO API	No internet, or WHO is down. Not yours to fix	Nothing. Your national update is safe – upload it and move on
The site shows “Could not load dashboard data”	The Data folder is missing, or nested one level too deep	Check that Data sits directly beside index.html in the repository
The site shows old numbers	The commit has not deployed yet, or Excel was left unsaved	Wait two minutes and refresh. If still wrong, redo Part 3
A province is missing from the map	Its name does not match Lookup_Lists – usually a typo or stray space	Correct the spelling in the entry sheet and run the update again

Part 7: Things to hand on

None of these break anything today, but whoever takes this over should know about them.

The week number in the page header is typed by hand

The line reading “DHF Weekly Report – Week 27, 2026” at the top of the dashboard is fixed text inside index.html. No script updates it. If that label matters to your audience, edit it by hand and upload index.html that once.

Age-group comparison has no 2025 baseline

The **National_AgeGroup_Entry** sheet holds 2026 rows only, so the age chart draws 2025 as zero – which reads as if nobody of any age caught dengue in 2025. The workbook’s own QA check number 8 already flags this. Adding the four 2025 age rows fixes it.

January 2027 will mislabel every year

The data file names its fields after 2026 and 2025 regardless of the actual year. The first time 2027 data is added, **the numbers will be correct but every label will still say 2026**. Nothing shows an error; it just quietly reads a year behind. Budget a short piece of development work before the new year.

The workbook is the only irreplaceable file

Everything else can be rebuilt: the national data file regenerates from the workbook, and the WHO files re-download. **Dengue_Master_Data_Entry.xlsx cannot**. Keep it backed up.

A public GitHub Pages site is readable by anyone with the link. The figures published here are aggregate province and month counts with no personal information, but if the National Dengue Control Program treats any of it as pre-release, confirm before publishing.